Reading Comprehension: Non-Fiction

Year 4 Pt 2 · **Mark Scheme**

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Retrieval & Fact vs Opinion

1. 5,895 metres above sea level.
2. Tanzania.
3. A) 'Mount Kilimanjaro is the tallest mountain in Africa.'
4. Enough energy to power a television for three hours.
5. Nearly half.
6. A) 'in my opinion'
7. Around one third.
8. Up to 60,000 bees.
9. A, B and E (the other statements are opinions about importance/difficulty, not facts).
10. Over 21,000 kilometres.
11. Over 2,000 years ago.
12. A) 'The Great Wall is the most impressive structure ever built.'
13. Between 9 and 11 hours.
14. Concentration and mood (also acceptable: memory).
15. A) A fact, since it is based on expert recommendations

Purpose, Audience & Main Idea

16. To persuade/advertise — to convince parents to buy the wrinkle-free school uniform.
17. A) Parents of school-age children
18. Persuasive, upbeat/enthusiastic, and reassuring.
19. To inform visitors about the gallery's opening hours and what they can see.
20. Neutral/informative and factual.
21. A) It gives practical information about visiting the Natural History Gallery
22. To present both sides of a discussion/debate about homework (a discursive, balanced purpose).
23. A) Balanced and even-handed
24. That there are valid arguments both for and against homework.
25. To persuade readers to donate money to the charity.
26. The general public/potential donors (likely adults who can give money).
27. A, B and C (no table of statistics or joke is used).
28. To instruct/explain how to carry out a process (a recipe method).
29. Neutral, clear, and instructional.
30. A) Chronological/sequential steps

Persuasive Techniques & Inference

31. 'How much longer can we ignore the plastic choking our oceans?' (or 'Isn't it time we acted?')
32. A) They make the reader stop and consider the issue, implying there is an obvious answer
33. 'innocent creatures' — this emotive phrasing makes the reader feel sympathy and anger, strengthening the persuasive impact.
34. 'Nine out of ten dentists recommend this toothpaste.'

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35. A) Precise numbers sound more scientific and convincing, increasing the reader's trust
36. Appeal to authority/expert opinion (also a bandwagon effect — suggesting that because most experts agree, the reader should too).
37. 'fastest, strongest and most reliable' (also 'live, work and play') — three adjectives/verbs listed together for persuasive rhythm.
38. A, B and E (there is no quotation from a scientist in the extract).
39. A) This is an exaggerated claim typical of advertising and may not be literally true
40. 'Residents are furious' / 'abandoning our community' — emotionally charged language.
41. 'How can the council justify abandoning our community like this?'
42. A) To show the closure would affect almost everyone in the community, broadening sympathy for the cause
43. 'Why pay more for less?' and 'isn't it time you made the smarter choice?'
44. It directly contrasts the rival as worse value (more sugar, more expensive), encouraging the reader to assume this product is automatically the healthier and cheaper — and therefore smarter — choice, even though no information about this product's own sugar content is actually given.
45. A rhetorical question combined with direct address, used to involve the reader personally and nudge them towards agreeing.

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Homework Worksheet — Answers

Retrieval & Fact vs Opinion

1. 8,849 metres above sea level.
2. Nepal and China.
3. A) 'Mount Everest reaches 8,849 metres.'
4. Up to 500 years.
5. A small charge for plastic bags.
6. A) 'frankly'
7. Three.
8. Solve simple puzzles and open jars.
9. A, B and D (the other statements are opinions comparing octopuses to other animals).
10. Approximately 9.2 million square kilometres.
11. 45°C.
12. A) 'The Sahara is the most boring place to visit.'
13. Poorer sleep and reduced physical activity.
14. That it should be limited.
15. A) A fact, since it is presented as a finding from health guidelines/research

Purpose, Audience & Main Idea

16. To persuade/advertise — to encourage readers to join the gym.
17. A) Adults considering getting fitter
18. Persuasive, energetic/upbeat, and encouraging.
19. To inform the reader about tomorrow's weather forecast.
20. Neutral/informative and factual.
21. A) It gives a summary of tomorrow's expected weather
22. To present both sides of the debate about later school start times.
23. A) Balanced and even-handed
24. That there are reasonable arguments both for and against starting school later.
25. To persuade readers to support/donate to a wildlife conservation charity.
26. The general public/potential donors concerned about wildlife.
27. A, B and C (there is no diagram or joke in the extract).
28. To instruct readers on what to do during a fire alarm/drill.
29. Calm, clear, and instructional/authoritative.
30. A) Sequential/chronological instructions

Standard / Advanced

31. A) Bandwagon appeal — suggesting the reader should follow what many others already do
32. It uses a minimising/anchoring technique by pairing a very small amount of money with an enormous outcome ('save a life'), making the donation seem like an easy, low-cost decision so the reader feels more willing to give.
33. This uses emotive/sensational language (and capitalisation for emphasis) to exaggerate reaction, making the reader feel curious or excited enough to want to read further.
34. This is a rhetorical question, phrased so there is really only one sensible answer — subtly pushing the reader towards agreeing that safety (and therefore buying the product) is the obviously correct choice.
35. This uses a sense of urgency/exclusivity ('before everyone else does'), playing on the reader's fear of missing out (FOMO) on something special.

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36. 'Isn't it time we asked ourselves what kind of world we are leaving behind?'
37. A) Bandwagon appeal, suggesting the reader should join because many others already have
38. The extreme contrast between the short time straws are used and the extremely long time they take to decompose is designed to shock the reader into realising how wasteful and damaging the habit is, making them more likely to support the campaign.
39. 'Clinically proven to reduce fine lines by 40% in just four weeks.'
40. A, B and C (there is no quotation from a dermatologist and no onomatopoeia).
41. A) A large number of people liking something does not prove scientifically that it is effective — popularity is not the same as proof
42. 'drowning in litter' / 'poisoning fish, birds and the water we all depend on' — emotionally charged language.
43. By including 'we all', the writer connects the pollution problem directly to the reader's own life and wellbeing, suggesting that everyone — not just environmental campaigners — has a personal stake in solving it.
44. 'faster, more reliable and cheaper' — three comparative adjectives listed together.
45. A) It sounds convincing but provides no real evidence to support it, which is a common persuasive trick

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